

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Pritzker wary of Trump's pivot

President says he'll deploy Guard where they'll be welcomed

By Rick Pearson and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker reacted with caution Wednesday to President Donald Trump's comments that he planned to deploy National Guard troops to a city and state where they would be welcomed to deter crime, unlike Chicago where Pritzker and local officials have called a presidential troop mobilization unnecessary, illegal and unwarranted.

"I'm not convinced that we're not going to see military troops on the ground," Pritzker said. "We don't know. I mean, I wish the president would again recognize that military troops in American cities are something that just doesn't belong. And he should not be ordering them into American cities."

Pritzker said sources connected to the Trump administration who have been providing him and his administration with information about a potential Guard deployment have been silent in recent days.

"They're not calling us now, which I think is a good sign. It is a sign that they are not hearing things that are suspiciously like, 'We're going to see military troops coming,'" Pritzker said. "I'm not saying anything definitive other than I take it that the silence of the last day or two from those folks is an indication that maybe there's some other place or other focus

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'Blitz' puts local, federal enforcement in spotlight

DHS blasts 11 inmates' release, but holding them in state takes court order

By Caroline Kubzansky and Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

As it advertised its so-called Operation Midway Blitz in Chicago, the Department of Homeland Security used social media to broadcast a now-familiar refrain.

In a string of posts on the platform X, the agency blasted state and local laws that restrict local authorities from participating in federal immigration enforcement. Officials included photographs of 11 men they called the "worst of the worst" who have been released from local jails and prisons, despite requests from ICE for administrative detainees.

Gov. JB Pritzker, in turn, has shot back that the Trump administration is trying to scare people, rather than work with officials to find real solutions to the city's violence.

At its heart, the argument is rooted in long-held legislation, public policy and case law that separates immigration enforcement from local law enforcement activity — a wall that some experts and advocates say exists for good reason.

And law enforcement experts, legal scholars and advocates say any local jail or sheriff's office, regardless of their state's political posture toward immigrants, faces significant constitutional concerns in deciding whether to cooperate with federal authorities.

Though all 11 men had contact

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The crowd reacts after Charlie Kirk, the CEO and co-founder of the conservative youth organization Turning Point USA, is shot at Utah Valley University on Wednesday in Orem, Utah. **TESS CROWLEY/THE DESERET NEWS PHOTOS**

Conservative activist killed at Utah college

Charlie Kirk, Chicago-area native and ally of president, shot; governor calls it political assassination

By Hannah Schoenbaum, Alanna Durkin Richer and Mark Sherman
Associated Press

OREM, Utah — Charlie Kirk, a conservative activist and close ally of President Donald Trump who played an influential role in rallying young Republican voters, was shot and killed Wednesday at a Utah college event in what the governor called a political assassination carried out from a rooftop. A person of interest was in custody, officials said.

"This is a dark day for our state. It's a tragic day for our nation," said Utah Gov. Spencer Cox. "I want to be very clear this is a political assassination."

Authorities did not immediately identify the person in custody, a motive or any criminal charges, but the circumstances of the shooting drew renewed attention to an escalating threat of political violence in the United States that in the last several years has cut across the ideological spectrum. The FBI, which investigates such acts, was helping lead the inquiry, though offi-



Charlie Kirk speaks during Turning Point's visit to Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah, on Wednesday.

cials said at this point they had no reason to believe a second person was involved.

Videos posted to social media from Utah Valley University show Kirk speaking into a hand-

held microphone while sitting under a white tent emblazoned with the slogans "The American Comeback" and "Prove Me Wrong." A single shot is fired and Kirk can be seen reaching

up with his right hand as a large volume of blood gushes from the left side of his neck. Stunned spectators are heard gasping and screaming before people start to run away. Associated Press was able to confirm the videos were taken at Sorensen Center courtyard on the Utah Valley University campus.

The shooter, who Cox pledged would be held accountable in a state with the death penalty, wore dark clothing and fired from a roof on campus some distance away.

Kirk was speaking at a debate hosted by his nonprofit political organization. Immediately before the shooting, Kirk was taking questions for an audience member about mass shootings and gun violence.

"Do you know how many transgender Americans have been mass shooters over the last 10 years?" an audience member asked. Kirk responded, "Too many."

The questioner followed up: "Do you know how many mass

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Native plants gaining ground with gardeners



A male monarch butterfly sits atop a cone flower in Amanda Nugent's garden in Wilmette on Aug. 25. She has spent years cultivating a garden full of native plants and flowers that attract varieties of native bees and wasps in her vast suburban garden. **STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE**

People turn to them for looks and to try to save bees, butterflies

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

On a quiet street in Wilmette, native plants bloom in broad sweeps and bright bursts, bringing color and life to what was once an ordinary strip of lawn separating the sidewalk from the curb.

The violet blossoms of blue vervain hover above clusters of frosty-white mountain mint, golden lanceleaf coreopsis, orange butterfly weed and pink poppy mallow. Monarch butterflies visit the buffet of pollen and nectar, as do wasps, bees, bugs and moths.

Humans pause as well, with a passing bicyclist turning her head to look and a man in an orange Kia pulling to a full stop.

"Awesome!" the man calls out to Amanda Nugent, who is standing nearby. "Is this your stuff?"

"It is," Nugent says with a smile.

At a time of growing concern about declines in insect populations, native plants are having a moment, with local fans such as Nugent showcasing them in parkways and front yards and community garden walks featuring them alongside the traditional roses, salvias and lilies.

National trend data isn't readily available, but the Northern Illinois Native Plant Gardeners Facebook page recently reached

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NATO planes down Russian drones

Multiple Russian drones crossed into Poland, in what European officials described Wednesday as a deliberate provocation, causing NATO to send fighter jets to shoot them down. **Nation & World**

'Everybody's go-to guy' returns to Cubs

Anthony Rizzo, one of the stars of the 2016 championship team that ended the historic 108-year drought, will retire as a Cub and join the organization as a team ambassador. **Chicago Sports**

